

Connecting Your *Google Calendar*

A one-time setup that lets your website automatically block booked dates, add new consultations to your calendar, and prevent double-bookings — all with a single click for your future you.

~5

MINUTES

\$0

COST

4

STEPS

1×

ONLY

PREPARED FOR **SWELLBALLOONS@GMAIL.COM**

BEFORE WE BEGIN

What this is, and why we're doing it

Your new booking system needs permission to read and write to your Google Calendar. That way, when a client books a consultation on your website, it automatically appears on your calendar — and when you block off a day for a personal appointment, your website automatically hides that day from your booking calendar.

Google (rightly!) doesn't just hand out that permission. You have to grant it, tied to **your own Google account**. This guide walks you through the tiny bit of Google setup required — it's a one-time task, takes about five minutes, and is completely free.

WHY YOU HAVE TO DO THIS (NOT YOUR WEB DEVELOPER)

If your developer created it under their Google account instead, your booking system would break the moment they deleted the project — and every security email from Google would go to them instead of you. Doing it under your own account keeps you in full control forever.

What you'll end up sending back

At the end of Step 4, Google will show you **two values** that look something like this:

```
Client ID:      847293847-abc123xyz.apps.googleusercontent.com
Client Secret:  GOCSPX-aB3cD4eF5gH6iJ7kL8mN9oP0
```

Copy both, and send them to your developer through a secure channel — a password manager like **1Password**, an encrypted message, or a service like **Signal**. Don't send them in a plain email if you can help it.

TREAT THESE LIKE A HOUSE KEY

Anyone who has both values can talk to Google as though they were you. Once your developer has them, delete them from any chat threads or notes.

1

Create a Google Cloud project

ABOUT 60 SECONDS

- 1 Open console.cloud.google.com in your browser.
- 2 Sign in with your Gmail (`swellballoons@gmail.com`).
- 3 At the very top of the page, click the **project dropdown** (it usually says "Select a project"), then click **New Project** in the top-right of the pop-up.
- 4 Give the project a name: `Swell design bookings` (any name is fine).
- 5 Leave the "Organization" field as-is (it's usually blank or "No organization"), and click **Create**.
- 6 Wait about 10 seconds for Google to create the project, then **select it** from that same top dropdown.

HOW TO TELL IT WORKED

Your project name (Swell design bookings) should now appear in the top bar of the console instead of "Select a project".

2

Turn on the Google Calendar service

ABOUT 30 SECONDS

- 1 In the search bar at the top of the console, type `Calendar API` .
- 2 In the results, click **Google Calendar API**.
- 3 Click the big blue **Enable** button.
- 4 Wait a few seconds. When the page changes to show a dashboard for the Calendar API, you're done with this step.

3

Fill out the "consent screen"

ABOUT 2 MINUTES

This is the screen your future self will see when clicking "Sign in with Google" — you're telling Google what to display on it.

- 1 In the left sidebar, click **APIs & Services**, then **OAuth consent screen**. (If prompted "Get Started", click it.)
 - 2 Choose **External** as the User Type, then click **Create**.
 - 3 Fill out **App information**:
 - **App name**: `swell design + media`
 - **User support email**: `swellballoons@gmail.com`
 - **App logo**: optional (skip if you don't have a square PNG handy)
 - 4 Fill out **App domain** (all fields are optional, but nicer for the consent screen):
 - **Application home page**: `https://swelldesignla.com`
 - **Privacy policy**: `https://swelldesignla.com/privacy`
 - **Terms of service**: `https://swelldesignla.com/terms`
 - 5 Under **Authorized domains**, click "+ Add domain" and enter `swelldesignla.com`.
 - 6 **Developer contact**: `swellballoons@gmail.com`.
 - 7 Click **Save and continue**.
 - 8 On the **Scopes** page, click **Add or remove scopes**. Search for and tick each of:
 - `.../auth/calendar.events`
 - `.../auth/calendar.readonly`
 - `.../auth/userinfo.email`
 - `.../auth/userinfo.profile`
- Click **Update**, then **Save and continue**.
- 9 On the **Test users** page, click + **Add users** and add `swellballoons@gmail.com` (and any teammate's Gmail if you want them to be able to connect too).
 - 10 Click **Save and continue**, then **Back to dashboard**.

LEAVE "PUBLISHING STATUS" AS *TESTING*

You do NOT need Google verification. Keeping it in "Testing" mode is intentional — it means only the emails you list as Test Users can connect. That's perfect for a single-designer site, and it saves you a ~2 week Google review process. You can list up to 100 test users, so you'll never run out.

4

Create your OAuth Client ID

ABOUT 60 SECONDS — THIS IS WHERE THE TWO VALUES YOU'LL SEND BACK COME FROM

- 1 In the left sidebar, click **APIs & Services**, then **Credentials**.
- 2 At the top, click + **Create Credentials**, then **OAuth client ID**.
- 3 Set **Application type** to `Web application`.
- 4 Set **Name** to `Swell backend`.
- 5 Under **Authorized redirect URIs**, click + **Add URI** and paste each of the following on a *separate* line (add all three — takes 15 seconds and prevents future headaches):
 - `https://swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback`
 - `https://www.swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback`
 - `https://balloon-decor-cms.preview.emergentagent.com/api/integrations/google/callback`
- 6 Click the blue **Create** button.
- 7 A pop-up will appear showing your **Client ID** and **Client Secret**. This is what you need to send back.

What this screen looks like

GOOGLE CLOUD CONSOLE — CREATE OAUTH CLIENT ID

Application type

Web application

Name

Swell backend

Authorized redirect URIs

https://swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback

https://www.swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback

https://balloon-decor-cms.preview.emergentagent.com/api/integrations/google/callback

Create

After clicking Create, you'll see this pop-up:

OAuth Client Created

Your Client ID

847293847-abc123xyz.apps.googleusercontent.com

Your Client Secret

GOCSPX-aB3cD4eF5gH6iJ7kL8mN9oP0

↑ These two values are what you'll send back to your developer. You can also click *Download JSON* to save them as a file.

REFERENCE

Three things on that screen — and what each one is

You'll see three "things" on the Create OAuth client screen. It's easy to confuse them, so here's what each one actually is:

NAME	EXAMPLE	WHO CREATES IT	WHERE IT GOES
Redirect URI	<code>https://swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback</code>	You type it in (it's your website's return address)	Stays inside Google
Client ID	<code>847293847-abc123xyz.apps.googleusercontent.com</code>	Google generates it for you	Copy & send to your developer
Client Secret	<code>GOCSPX-aB3cD4eF5gH6iJ7kL8mN9oP0</code>	Google generates it for you	Copy & send to your developer

A HELPFUL ANALOGY

Think of it like setting up mail forwarding at the post office. The **Redirect URI** is *your home address* — you tell Google where to send things. The **Client ID** is *your account number* — Google gives it to you so it knows who's asking. The **Client Secret** is *your PIN* — Google gives it to you, and you keep it private.

Why the Redirect URI has to be exact

Google will only send visitors back to a URL that *exactly* matches one you registered. Even tiny differences count as a mismatch:

URL	MATCH?	WHY
<code>https://swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback</code>	✓	The reference

URL	MATCH?	WHY
<code>https://www.swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback</code>	✗	Extra "www."
<code>http://swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback</code>	✗	http vs https
<code>https://swelldesignla.com/api/integrations/google/callback/</code>	✗	Trailing slash
<code>https://SwellDesignLA.com/api/integrations/google/callback</code>	✗	Uppercase letters

That's why the guide asks you to add three variations — with `www.`, without `www.`, and the preview URL. It covers every place your site might send visitors back from.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER YOU SEND THE VALUES

Your one-time click, forever

Once your developer has the two values, they'll paste them into the server that runs your website (about 30 seconds on their side). Then you'll do this *one time*, and then never again:

- 1 Log into your admin dashboard on `swelldesignla.com/admin`.
- 2 Go to **Integrations** in the sidebar.
- 3 Under "Google Calendar" you'll see a big button: **Sign in with Google**. Click it.
- 4 Google will show you a familiar sign-in screen. Pick `swellballoons@gmail.com`, click **Allow**.
- 5 You'll be sent back to the admin dashboard, and it'll say **Connected as swellballoons@gmail.com**.

THAT'S IT — THE SETUP IS DONE FOREVER

From this moment on, every consultation your clients book on the website will automatically appear on your Google Calendar, and any personal events on your calendar will automatically block those times from being booked on the website. No manual work, no double-bookings, no back-and-forth.

Troubleshooting

"Access blocked: swell design has not completed the Google verification process"

Your Gmail isn't in the Test Users list yet. Go back to **Step 3, item 9** and add `swellballoons@gmail.com` as a Test User.

"Error 400: redirect_uri_mismatch"

The URL your browser is trying to go back to doesn't exactly match any of the ones you registered in Step 4, item 5. The error page will show which URL was attempted — copy it, and add it to the list of Authorized redirect URIs in Google Cloud.

"invalid_client"

The Client ID or Client Secret your developer entered on the server doesn't match what Google shows. Ask them to double-check by comparing to what's shown in your Google Cloud Console (Credentials → click the OAuth client you created).

"Nothing happens when I click Sign in with Google"

Your developer needs to check the server logs. Usually this means the credentials weren't picked up. They'll know what to do.

Where to get the values again if you lose them

- 1 Go to console.cloud.google.com and select your *Swell design bookings* project.
- 2 Sidebar → **APIs & Services** → **Credentials**.
- 3 Click the OAuth client named **Swell backend**.
- 4 The Client ID is shown on-screen. To see the Client Secret again, click "Reset secret" (this will invalidate the old one — only do this if you truly lost it, and let your developer know so they can update the server).

Ready to send your developer?

Before you send those two values, do a quick sanity check:

- ☐ You completed **all four steps**.
- ☐ Your Gmail is listed under **Test Users** (Step 3, item 9).
- ☐ You added **at least the two URIs** with and without `www.` (Step 4, item 5).
- ☐ You copied the **Client ID** — it ends in `.apps.googleusercontent.com`
- ☐ You copied the **Client Secret** — it starts with `GOCSPX-`
- ☐ You're sending both values through a **secure channel** (password manager, encrypted message), not plain email.

Thank you for taking the time to do this — it's the one bit of "grown-up software" work that has to happen under your own name, and once it's done, it's done forever. Any questions, just ask.